disintegration of the Soviet Union. Once that objective was achieved, the Tibet issue was brought back once again on the front burner. So, the SFJ leaders and other pro-Khalistan elements should remain ready to move from the front burner to the back burner or even into cold storage, depending on the convenience of their host countries.

Pakistan is using pro-Khalistan elements in the same manner as Indira Gandhi had used Bhindranwale to further her party's prospects. However, the end result of such operations proves usually disastrous for the persons or parties who allow themselves to be used for furthering their controllers' interests. Their handlers, at the most, stand to lose a certain amount of money, time and resources spent on such operations, in the hope that the risk-reward ratio might one day turn in their favour and pay dividends on their original investment.

It is understandable, therefore, that a certain number of persons involved in pro-Khalistan activities are directly or indirectly being financially compensated by the ISI and are also drawing pecuniary and other benefits resulting from their presence in certain Western countries. Logical arguments will have no effect on such people. My advice to Sikhs who join or support such protests even if it is out of mere curiosity is to see through their game of destabilizing Punjab, which has still not fully recovered from the consequences of a disastrous decade and a half following the launch of Op-2 by Indira Gandhi.

Knowing Sikh history fairly well, I can say that no amount of ISI propaganda can shake the loyalty of the Sikhs of Punjab towards their country. Their contributions towards India's Independence cannot be written off with one stroke of the pen. India had always belonged to the Sikhs and they will continue to belong to India.

I was, however, dismayed to read a news item about the projection of a large photograph of Bhindranwale outside Gurdwara Sri Guru Singh Sabha in Southall, London, next to the image of the fifth Sikh Guru Arjan Dev, to mark the occasion of the guru's martyrdom day on 5 June 2020. [12] What a contrast. Guru Arjan Dev made major contributions towards raising the Sikh edifice over the foundation laid by Guru Nanak and gave his life for protecting the